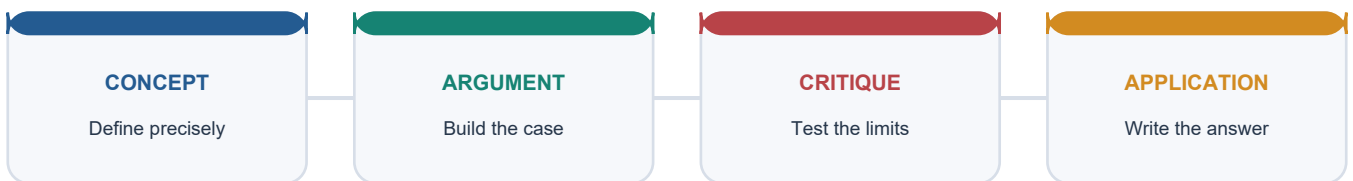


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Globalisation and Challenges to Sovereignty - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Globalisation and Challenges to Sovereignty - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 12 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Imperialism**?

- A. domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism (PDF pp.209-210).
- B. Production, capital and labour cross borders through MNCs, eroding a state's exclusive control over its own economic space (PDF pp.210-212, 214-217).
- C. two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.
- D. formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Imperialism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Market, not Imperialism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba), not Imperialism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Neo-colonialism, not Imperialism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Imperialism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Colonialism**?

- A. sees imperialism as linked to capitalist expansion in search of markets, investment outlets and raw materials (PDF p.210).
- B. implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209).
- C. helps distinguish imperialism from colonialism by separating broader domination from settlement-based control (PDF p.209).
- D. pressure on sovereignty changes how it operates; it does not automatically dissolve the state as a legal actor.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Lenin, not Colonialism.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Colonialism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Edward Said, not Colonialism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Constraint vs disappearance, not Colonialism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Colonialism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Neo-colonialism**?

- A. two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.
- B. Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action (PDF pp.212-214).
- C. formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).
- D. the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF pp.209-212).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba), not Neo-colonialism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Power blocs, not Neo-colonialism.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Neo-colonialism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Imperialism vs neo-colonialism, not Neo-colonialism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Neo-colonialism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Power blocs**?

- A. the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF pp.209-212).
- B. formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).
- C. two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.
- D. Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action (PDF pp.212-214).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Imperialism vs neo-colonialism, not Power blocs.
- **B:** B Attaches to Neo-colonialism, not Power blocs.
- **C:** C Attaches to Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba), not Power blocs.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Power blocs.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Power blocs by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Globalization**?

- A. worldwide interdependence in production, markets, communication and culture; Gauba also describes it as a conscious policy linked to liberalization and.
- B. globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness.
- C. relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding.
- D. international law may still recognize sovereign equality, but real capacity varies sharply across states (read with Gauba's external challenge framing in PDF).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Globalization.
- **B:** B Attaches to Gauba's balanced appraisal, not Globalization.
- **C:** C Attaches to Liberalization / privatization, not Globalization.
- **D:** D Attaches to Legal sovereignty vs actual power, not Globalization.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Globalization by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Liberalization / privatization**?

- A. international law may still recognize sovereign equality, but real capacity varies sharply across states (read with Gauba's external challenge framing in PDF pp.209, 212-218).
- B. relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding.
- C. a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital, technology, price-setting or institutions abroad (PDF pp.210-212).
- D. Gauba treats interdependence as an emerging reality and also describes policy globalization as a deliberate extension of liberalization and privatization (PDF pp.214-217).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Legal sovereignty vs actual power, not Liberalization / privatization.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Liberalization / privatization.
- **C:** C Attaches to Formal independence vs effective autonomy, not Liberalization / privatization.
- **D:** D Attaches to Globalization as process vs globalization as policy, not Liberalization / privatization.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Liberalization / privatization by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba)**?

- A. formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).
- B. Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action (PDF pp.212-214).
- C. two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.
- D. the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF pp.209-212).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Neo-colonialism, not Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba).
- **B:** B Attaches to Power blocs, not Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba).
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba).
- **D:** D Attaches to Imperialism vs neo-colonialism, not Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba).

Examiner trap: Do not identify Pooled and delegated sovereignty (analytical addition, not in Gauba) by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **IMF and World Bank**?

- A. Multinational Corporations (MNCs): already named in Gauba's neo-colonialism discussion as vehicles of capital investment, cheap-labour use and profit repatriation that narrow a developing state's practical economic autonomy even after formal independence (PDF pp.210-212)
- B. World Trade Organization (WTO) (contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text): treaty negotiation and collective rule-making contain a pooled element, while authorising panels or adjudicators to apply agreed rules is a delegated element. Both rest on consented treaty commitments rather than unilateral external command. Verify the current operational status of particular dispute-settlement stages from an official WTO source before making a dated claim; do not present this illustration as a Gauba citation
- C. Nkrumah popularised and systematised neo-colonialism for an international audience in his 1965 book Neo-colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism.
- D. IMF and World Bank: Gauba's own text names these as the "Western-dominated agencies" whose loan/structural-adjustment terms and conditions developing countries are said to accept under globalisation (PDF pp.216-217, IMF concessional assistance discussed at p.217). This is a consented but often unequal external constraint, not delegation: the borrowing state accepts conditions attached to finance, but the lender does not thereby exercise a defined sovereign function on the state's behalf

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Multinational Corporations (MNCs), not IMF and World Bank.
- **B:** B Attaches to World Trade Organization (WTO) (CURRENT: contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text), not IMF and World Bank.
- **C:** C Attaches to Kwame Nkrumah, not IMF and World Bank.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for IMF and World Bank.

Examiner trap: Do not identify IMF and World Bank by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Multinational Corporations (MNCs) - Multinational Corporations (MNCs): already named in Gauba's neo-colonialism discussion as vehicles of capital investment, cheap-labour use and profit repatriation that narrow a developing state's practical economic autonomy even after formal independence (PDF pp.210-212)
- B. State - worldwide interdependence in production, markets, communication and culture; Gauba also describes it as a conscious policy linked to liberalization.
- C. Citizenship - relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment.
- D. Gauba's balanced appraisal - international law may still recognize sovereign equality, but real capacity varies sharply across states (read with Gauba's.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Faithful pairing: Multinational Corporations (MNCs) is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: State is recorded with Policy autonomy narrows under IMF/World Bank conditionality, WTO treaty commitments and delegated adjudicative procedures; regulatory functions may also be pooled in common institutions (PDF pp.216-217 for IMF/World Bank).
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Citizenship is recorded with Global communication, migration and transnational civil-society networks widen a citizen's frame of reference and rights-claims beyond the territorial state (synthesis, not a direct Gauba citation).

- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Gauba's balanced appraisal is recorded with globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness, but may also deepen domination and inequality (PDF pp.217-218).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Multinational Corporations (MNCs); nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. IMF and World Bank - Policy autonomy narrows under IMF/World Bank conditionality, WTO treaty commitments and delegated adjudicative procedures; regulatory functions may also be pooled in common institutions (PDF pp.216-217 for IMF/World Bank)
- B. World Trade Organization (WTO) (CURRENT: contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text) - World Trade Organization (WTO) (contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text): treaty negotiation and collective rule-making contain a pooled element, while authorising panels or adjudicators to apply agreed rules is a delegated element. Both rest on consented treaty commitments rather than unilateral external command. Verify the current operational status of particular dispute-settlement stages from an official WTO source before making a dated claim; do not present this illustration as a Gauba citation
- C. Kwame Nkrumah - Global communication, migration and transnational civil-society networks widen a citizen's frame of reference and rights-claims beyond the territorial state (synthesis, not a direct Gauba citation)
- D. Multinational Corporations (MNCs) - globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: IMF and World Bank is recorded with Gauba's own text names these as the "Western-dominated agencies" whose loan/structural-adjustment terms and conditions developing countries are said to accept under globalisation (PDF pp.216-217, IMF concessional assistance discussed at p.217). This is a consented but often unequal external constraint, not delegation: the borrowing state accepts conditions attached to finance, but the lender does not thereby exercise a defined sovereign function on the state's behalf.
- **B:** B Faithful pairing: World Trade Organization (WTO) (CURRENT: contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text) is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Kwame Nkrumah is recorded with Nkrumah popularised and systematised neo-colonialism for an international audience in his 1965 book Neo-colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism, explaining how formal independence may coexist with continued external control through international monetary bodies, world-market price-fixing, multinational corporations/cartels, and educational-cultural institutions (PDF pp.211-212).
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Multinational Corporations (MNCs) is recorded with already named in Gauba's neo-colonialism discussion as vehicles of capital investment, cheap-labour use and profit repatriation that narrow a developing state's practical economic autonomy even after formal independence (PDF pp.210-212).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to World Trade Organization (WTO) (CURRENT: contemporary institutional illustration, not named in Gauba's 2009-edition text); nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Legal sovereignty vs actual power - domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism.
- B. Globalization as process vs globalization as policy - worldwide interdependence in production, markets, communication and culture; Gauba also describes it as.
- C. Formal independence vs effective autonomy - a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital.
- D. Liberalization / privatization - globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Legal sovereignty vs actual power is recorded with international law may still recognize sovereign equality, but real capacity varies sharply across states (read with Gauba's external challenge framing in PDF pp.209, 212-218).
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Globalization as process vs globalization as policy is recorded with Gauba treats interdependence as an emerging reality and also describes policy globalization as a deliberate extension of liberalization and privatization (PDF pp.214-217).
- **C:** C Exact pair: Formal independence vs effective autonomy is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Liberalization / privatization is recorded with relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding globalization (PDF p.217).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Formal independence vs effective autonomy; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Liberalization / privatization - worldwide interdependence in production, markets, communication and culture; Gauba also describes it as a conscious policy.
- B. Globalization as process vs globalization as policy - domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction.
- C. Formal independence vs effective autonomy - globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge.
- D. Legal sovereignty vs actual power - international law may still recognize sovereign equality, but real capacity varies sharply across states (read with).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Liberalization / privatization is recorded with relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding globalization (PDF p.217).
- **B:** B Not this pair: Globalization as process vs globalization as policy is recorded with Gauba treats interdependence as an emerging reality and also describes policy globalization as a deliberate extension of liberalization and privatization (PDF pp.214-217).
- **C:** C Mismatched: Formal independence vs effective autonomy is recorded with a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital, technology, price-setting or institutions abroad (PDF pp.210-212).
- **D:** D Kept where the source puts it: Legal sovereignty vs actual power is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Legal sovereignty vs actual power; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Imperialism vs neo-colonialism - the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF).
- B. Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence - two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without.
- C. Neo-colonialism - helps distinguish imperialism from colonialism by separating broader domination from settlement-based control (PDF p.209).
- D. Power blocs - sees imperialism as linked to capitalist expansion in search of markets, investment outlets and raw materials (PDF p.210).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Correct attachment: Imperialism vs neo-colonialism is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence is recorded with one is bipolar strategic compulsion; the other is wider economic, technological, environmental and cultural linkage (PDF pp.212-218).
- **C:** C Cross-attached: Neo-colonialism is recorded with formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Power blocs is recorded with Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action (PDF pp.212-214).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Imperialism vs neo-colonialism; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Imperialism vs neo-colonialism - two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal.
- B. Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence - one is bipolar strategic compulsion; the other is wider economic, technological.
- C. Neo-colonialism - helps distinguish imperialism from colonialism by separating broader domination from settlement-based control (PDF p.209).
- D. Power blocs - sees imperialism as linked to capitalist expansion in search of markets, investment outlets and raw materials (PDF p.210).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Imperialism vs neo-colonialism is recorded with the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF pp.209-212).
- **B:** B Correct attachment: Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Neo-colonialism is recorded with formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Power blocs is recorded with Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action (PDF pp.212-214).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Power-bloc pressure vs global interdependence; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Liberalization / privatization - domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and.
- B. Formal independence vs effective autonomy - worldwide interdependence in production, markets, communication and culture; Gauba also describes it as a.
- C. Globalization as process vs globalization as policy - Gauba treats interdependence as an emerging reality and also describes policy globalization as a.
- D. Legal sovereignty vs actual power - globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Liberalization / privatization is recorded with relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding globalization (PDF p.217).
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Formal independence vs effective autonomy is recorded with a country may become legally sovereign after decolonization yet remain materially constrained by capital, technology, price-setting or institutions abroad (PDF pp.210-212).
- **C:** C Records the association: Globalization as process vs globalization as policy is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Misplaced: Legal sovereignty vs actual power is recorded with international law may still recognize sovereign equality, but real capacity varies sharply across states (read with Gauba's external challenge framing in PDF pp.209, 212-218).

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Globalization as process vs globalization as policy; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Lenin - the first often uses direct domination; the second uses indirect economic leverage and dependency after independence (PDF pp.209-212).
- B. Colonialism - interprets imperialism as a search for captive markets and attacks it as exploitation (PDF p.210).
- C. Edward Said - one is bipolar strategic compulsion; the other is wider economic, technological, environmental and cultural linkage (PDF pp.212-218).
- D. Constraint vs disappearance - pressure on sovereignty changes how it operates; it does not automatically dissolve the state as a legal actor.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Lenin is recorded with sees imperialism as linked to capitalist expansion in search of markets, investment outlets and raw materials (PDF p.210).
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Colonialism is recorded with implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209).
- **C:** C Misplaced: Edward Said is recorded with helps distinguish imperialism from colonialism by separating broader domination from settlement-based control (PDF p.209).

- **D:** D Source-exact: Constraint vs disappearance is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Constraint vs disappearance; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Edward Said** is associated with: helps distinguish imperialism from colonialism by separating broader domination from settlement-based control (PDF p.209).
2. **Kwame Nkrumah** is associated with: Global communication, migration and transnational civil-society networks widen a citizen's frame of reference and rights-claims beyond the territorial state (synthesis, not a direct Gauba citation).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Edward Said does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **J.A. Hobson** is associated with: globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness, but may also deepen domination and inequality (PDF pp.217-218).
2. **Gauba's balanced appraisal** is associated with: globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness, but may also deepen domination and inequality (PDF pp.217-218).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with J.A. Hobson does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Lenin** is associated with: sees imperialism as linked to capitalist expansion in search of markets, investment outlets and raw materials (PDF p.210).
2. **State** is associated with: Policy autonomy narrows under IMF/World Bank conditionality, WTO treaty commitments and delegated adjudicative procedures; regulatory functions may also be pooled in common institutions (PDF pp.216-217 for IMF/World Bank).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Lenin does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Kwame Nkrumah** is associated with: Production, capital and labour cross borders through MNCs, eroding a state's exclusive control over its own economic space (PDF pp.210-212, 214-217).
2. **Market** is associated with: formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Kwame Nkrumah does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Gauba's balanced appraisal** is associated with: globalization is presented with both promises and dangers; it may spread knowledge, communication and environmental awareness, but may also deepen domination and inequality (PDF pp.217-218).
2. **Citizenship** is associated with: Cold War-era superpower-led military-ideological camps that pressured weaker states and constrained independent action (PDF pp.212-214).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Gauba's balanced appraisal does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **State** is associated with: domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism (PDF pp.209-210).
2. **Imperialism** is associated with: domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism (PDF pp.209-210).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with State does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Market** is associated with: Production, capital and labour cross borders through MNCs, eroding a state's exclusive control over its own economic space (PDF pp.210-212, 214-217).
2. **Colonialism** is associated with: implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Market does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Citizenship** is associated with: formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).
2. **Neo-colonialism** is associated with: two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Citizenship does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Globalisation means sovereignty has disappeared."**?

- A. Gauba presents challenge, constraint and revision, not automatic extinction of the state (PDF pp.214-218).
- B. Gauba also links it to communication, culture and environmental spillovers (PDF pp.214-217).
- C. Gauba's whole neo-colonialism discussion shows that formal independence may coexist with deep dependency (PDF pp.210-212).
- D. IR handles institutions and current order; this Political Theory file studies what those forces do to the concept of sovereignty.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba presents challenge, constraint and revision, not automatic extinction of the state (PDF pp.214-218).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Globalisation is only economic.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Political independence solved the sovereignty problem.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "This topic belongs entirely to IR.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Globalisation means sovereignty has disappeared.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Political independence solved the sovereignty problem."**?

- A. Colonialism means implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209).
- B. Gauba's whole neo-colonialism discussion shows that formal independence may coexist with deep dependency (PDF pp.210-212).
- C. IR handles institutions and current order; this Political Theory file studies what those forces do to the concept of sovereignty.
- D. Gauba presents challenge, constraint and revision, not automatic extinction of the state (PDF pp.214-218).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Colonialism means two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba's whole neo-colonialism discussion shows that formal independence may coexist with deep dependency (PDF pp.210-212).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "This topic belongs entirely to IR.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Globalisation means sovereignty has disappeared.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Political independence solved the sovereignty, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Cold War examples in the chapter describe today's world as such.**"?

- A. IR handles institutions and current order; this Political Theory file studies what those forces do to the concept of sovereignty.
- B. Colonialism means implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209).
- C. NATO, Warsaw Pact, third-world and non-alignment references are book-period or historical illustrations from a 2009 text (PDF pp.212-214).
- D. Gauba's whole neo-colonialism discussion shows that formal independence may coexist with deep dependency (PDF pp.210-212).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "This topic belongs entirely to IR.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Colonialism means two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: NATO, Warsaw Pact, third-world and non-alignment references are book-period or historical illustrations from a 2009 text (PDF pp.212-214).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Political independence solved the sovereignty problem.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Cold War examples in the chapter describe today's, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Globalisation is only economic.**"?

- A. IR handles institutions and current order; this Political Theory file studies what those forces do to the concept of.
- B. Gauba presents challenge, constraint and revision, not automatic extinction of the state (PDF pp.214-218).
- C. Gauba's whole neo-colonialism discussion shows that formal independence may coexist with deep dependency (PDF pp.210-212).
- D. Gauba also links it to communication, culture and environmental spillovers (PDF pp.214-217).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "This topic belongs entirely to IR.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Globalisation means sovereignty has disappeared.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Political independence solved the sovereignty problem.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba also links it to communication, culture and environmental spillovers (PDF pp.214-217).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Globalisation is only economic.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"This topic belongs entirely to IR."**?

- A. IR handles institutions and current order; this Political Theory file studies what those forces do to the concept of sovereignty.
- B. Colonialism means implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209).
- C. Gauba's whole neo-colonialism discussion shows that formal independence may coexist with deep dependency (PDF pp.210-212).
- D. NATO, Warsaw Pact, third-world and non-alignment references are book-period or historical illustrations from a 2009 text (PDF pp.212-214).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: IR handles institutions and current order; this Political Theory file studies what those forces do to the concept of sovereignty.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Colonialism means two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Political independence solved the sovereignty problem.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Cold War examples in the chapter describe today's world as such.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "This topic belongs entirely to IR.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Imperialism means relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding globalization (PDF p.217).**?

- A. Colonialism means implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209).
- B. Imperialism means domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism.
- C. NATO, Warsaw Pact, third-world and non-alignment references are book-period or historical illustrations from a 2009 text (PDF pp.212-214).
- D. Neo-colonialism means formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Colonialism means two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Imperialism means domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism (PDF pp.209-210).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Cold War examples in the chapter describe today's world as such.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Neo-colonialism means Gauba's own text names these as the "Western-dominated agencies" whose loan/structural-adjustment terms and conditions developing countries are

said to accept under globalisation (PDF pp.216-217, IMF concessional assistance discussed at p.217). This is a consented but often unequal external constraint, not delegation: the borrowing state accepts conditions attached to finance, but the lender does not thereby exercise a defined sovereign function on the state's behalf.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Imperialism means relaxation of state economic, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Colonialism means two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.?**

- A. NATO, Warsaw Pact, third-world and non-alignment references are book-period or historical illustrations from a 2009 text (PDF pp.212-214).
- B. IR handles institutions and current order; this Political Theory file studies what those forces do to the concept of sovereignty.
- C. Colonialism means implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209).
- D. Gauba's whole neo-colonialism discussion shows that formal independence may coexist with deep dependency (PDF pp.210-212).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Cold War examples in the chapter describe today's world as such.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "This topic belongs entirely to IR.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Colonialism means implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Political independence solved the sovereignty problem.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Colonialism means two distinct mechanisms by which, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Neo-colonialism means Gauba's own text names these as the "Western-dominated agencies" whose loan/structural-adjustment terms and conditions developing countries are said to accept under globalisation (PDF pp.216-217, IMF concessional assistance discussed at p.217). This is a consented but often unequal external constraint, not delegation: the borrowing state accepts conditions attached to finance, but the lender does not thereby exercise a defined sovereign function on the state's behalf.?**

- A. NATO, Warsaw Pact, third-world and non-alignment references are book-period or historical illustrations from a 2009 text (PDF pp.212-214).
- B. Imperialism means domination by a metropolitan centre over distant territories; Gauba cites Edward Said's distinction between imperialism and colonialism.
- C. Colonialism means implantation of settlements and direct rule in distant territory; a specific expression of imperialism (PDF p.209).
- D. Neo-colonialism means formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Cold War examples in the chapter describe today's world as such.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Imperialism means relaxation of state economic controls and transfer of state ownership to private hands, presented by Gauba as part of the policy environment feeding globalization (PDF p.217).', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Colonialism means two distinct mechanisms by which formally sovereign states reorganise the exercise of authority without losing legal sovereignty outright.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Neo-colonialism means formal political independence combined with continuing economic exploitation and dependency through subtler mechanisms (PDF pp.210-212).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Neo-colonialism means Gauba's own text names these, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

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ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish formal legal sovereignty from effective autonomy under globalisation. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of formal legal sovereignty from effective autonomy under globalisation in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Formal, Core and Legal, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Globalisation leaves juridical statehood intact while making effective autonomy a variable achievement shaped by material capacity, bargaining power and the terms of interdependence.

Model answer (140 words):

Introduction: Formal legal sovereignty and effective autonomy answer different questions about a state's external position. Core analysis: Legal sovereignty means recognised independence and equality: no foreign state possesses lawful title to govern the territory. Effective autonomy concerns whether the state has the material, technological, financial and strategic capacity to make meaningful choices. Gauba's sequence from colonialism to neo-colonialism shows why the two can diverge. A post-colonial state may possess a flag, constitution and international personality while dependence on capital, markets, technology or security guarantees narrows its policy space. Critical evaluation: External constraint is not automatically the same as legal subordination. Analysis must therefore ask who sets the terms, whether alternatives exist and how costs are distributed. Conclusion: Globalisation leaves juridical statehood intact while making effective autonomy a variable achievement shaped by material capacity, bargaining power and the terms of interdependence.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Formal, Core and Legal), converts that evidence into analysis of formal legal sovereignty from effective autonomy under globalisation, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Globalisation leaves juridical statehood intact while making effective autonomy a variable achievement shaped by material capacity, bargaining power and the terms of interdependence. At 140 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish imperialism, colonialism and neo-colonialism as challenges to sovereignty. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of imperialism, colonialism and neo-colonialism as challenges to sovereignty in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Imperialism, Core and Following Edward Said's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that legal decolonisation therefore does not guarantee substantive autonomy.

Model answer (146 words):

Introduction: Imperialism, colonialism and neo-colonialism describe related but distinct mechanisms through which one political economy dominates another. Core analysis: Following Edward Said's distinction, imperialism is the wider project of metropolitan domination, while colonialism is its settlement-based and directly territorial form. Colonial rule openly suppresses sovereignty through administration and extraction. Neo-colonialism persists after formal independence: external control works through trade structures, finance, technology, multinational corporations, pricing power and cultural institutions. Hobson interprets imperialism as exploitation in search of captive markets, Lenin links it structurally to capitalist expansion, and Nkrumah gives neo-colonial dependence its canonical modern formulation. Critical evaluation: The concepts should not be collapsed into a slogan. The decisive test is whether formally sovereign choice is systematically subordinated by unequal structures. Conclusion: The sequence moves from broad domination, through direct territorial rule, to formally independent but materially dependent statehood; legal decolonisation therefore does not guarantee substantive autonomy.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Imperialism, Core and Following Edward Said's), converts that evidence into analysis of imperialism, colonialism and neo-colonialism as challenges to sovereignty, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that legal decolonisation therefore does not guarantee substantive autonomy. At 146 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: How did power blocs constrain sovereignty, and what was the political significance of non-alignment? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive how requires the answer to state the mechanism step by step and show what each step produces. Fix the boundary of did power blocs constrain sovereignty, and what was the political significance of non-alignment in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Cold War, Core and Military, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that alignment could supply protection but also create pressure over bases, diplomacy, armament and development priorities.

Model answer (140 words):

Introduction: Cold War power blocs constrained sovereignty by making the security of weaker states dependent on rival superpower camps. Core analysis: Military alliances, ideological rivalry and external guarantees narrowed foreign-policy choice even where territorial independence remained legally intact. Alignment could supply protection but also create pressure over bases, diplomacy, armament and development priorities. Non-alignment under leaders such as Nehru, Nasser and Tito was therefore not passive neutrality. It attempted to preserve sovereign judgment, resist automatic camp discipline and create collective bargaining space for newly independent states. Its significance was normative and strategic: it asserted that juridically equal states should possess practical room to judge issues on their merits rather than inherit another power's enemies. Conclusion: Bloc politics narrowed strategic choice without abolishing statehood, while non-alignment asserted that weaker states could preserve decision-space through organised autonomy rather than compulsory camp membership.

Why this earns marks: it obeys how instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Cold War, Core and Military), converts that evidence into analysis of did power blocs constrain sovereignty, and what was the political significance of non-alignment, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that alignment could supply protection but also create pressure over bases, diplomacy, armament and development priorities. At 140 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Explain globalisation as both a process and a policy, with reference to pooled and delegated sovereignty. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive explain requires the answer to set out the concept, its mechanism and its consequences in a stated order. Fix the boundary of globalisation as both a process and a policy, with reference to pooled and delegated sovereignty in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Globalisation, Core and As, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Globalisation transforms sovereignty through consented but unequal institutional constraints;.

Model answer (215 words):

Introduction: Globalisation is both an objective intensification of cross-border interdependence and a policy project that deliberately liberalises markets and reallocates regulatory authority. Core analysis: As process, it connects production, finance, communication, culture and environmental consequences across borders. As policy, liberalisation and privatisation encourage cross-border movement of capital, technology, labour and goods. States pool authority through joint institutional decisions and delegate defined adjudicative, administrative or monitoring functions to treaty bodies. Loan conditionality is different: it is consented external constraint, not performance of a sovereign function on the borrower's behalf. Legal title persists, although practical discretion becomes shared or narrowed. Further development: The distinction clarifies responsibility. Technological or ecological interdependence is not fully chosen, whereas liberalisation, treaty accession and conditional borrowing are open to democratic scrutiny. Pooling can add collective leverage and delegation can add expertise; conditional lending remains a separate bargaining constraint. Each becomes problematic when accountability is bypassed or exit is only formal. Critical evaluation: Formal consent may conceal unequal bargaining power where finance or market access leaves few alternatives. Pooling, delegation and conditional constraint therefore describe different transformations whose legitimacy depends on reciprocity, accountability and meaningful review or exit. Conclusion: Globalisation transforms sovereignty through consented but unequal institutional constraints; pooling and delegation describe altered exercises of authority, not the automatic extinction of legal title.

Why this earns marks: it obeys explain instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Globalisation, Core and As), converts that evidence into analysis of globalisation as both a process and a policy, with reference to pooled and delegated sovereignty, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Globalisation transforms sovereignty through consented but unequal institutional constraints;. At 215 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Has globalisation ended sovereignty? Evaluate the hyperglobalist, sceptic and transformationalist positions. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive discuss requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of globalisation ended sovereignty? Evaluate the hyperglobalist, sceptic and transformationalist positions in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Hyperglobalists and Sceptics, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: The transformationalist judgment is strongest: states remain indispensable legal and political actors, but their capacities, functions and decision-sites are reconstituted through uneven transnational interdependence.

Model answer (239 words):

Introduction: The claim that globalisation has ended sovereignty confuses the erosion of insulation with the disappearance of legally and politically organised state authority. Core analysis: Hyperglobalists emphasise global markets, mobile capital, communication networks and transnational governance that displace national control. Sceptics answer that international trade and regional concentration are not wholly new, that states create the rules and that national institutions remain decisive. Transformationalists reject both extremes: globalisation reconstitutes functions, capacities and sites of decision through multilevel authority, pooled institutions and uneven networks. Gauba's balanced account is closest to this view because he calls for revision of external sovereignty rather than announcing its death. Further development: The 15 July 2026 entry into force of the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement offers a current conceptual anchor. The agreement creates new market-access and regulatory commitments because two sovereign governments negotiated and accepted common rules. It therefore

illustrates both persistence and transformation: state consent remains constitutive, but future policy choices operate inside a denser framework. The example cannot establish that every trade agreement is equal or beneficial; distributional effects, safeguards, domestic implementation and parliamentary scrutiny, and the practical costs of withdrawal remain separate empirical questions. The relevant question is therefore which powers are retained, shared or effectively lost, and whether the new arrangements remain democratically answerable. Conclusion: The transformationalist judgment is strongest: states remain indispensable legal and political actors, but their capacities, functions and decision-sites are reconstituted through uneven transnational interdependence.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *discuss* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Hyperglobalists and Sceptics), converts that evidence into analysis of globalisation ended sovereignty? Evaluate the hyperglobalist, sceptic and transformationalist positions, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: The transformationalist judgment is strongest: states remain indispensable legal and political actors, but their capacities, functions and decision-sites are reconstituted through uneven transnational interdependence. At 239 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Is globalisation merely a new form of neo-colonialism? Critically discuss. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive *is* requires the answer to take a side, defend it and concede the strongest point against it. Fix the boundary of globalisation merely a new form of neo-colonialism? Critically discuss in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Globalisation, Core and OPEC, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Globalisation can reproduce neo-colonial asymmetry, yet it also creates reciprocal institutions, new coalitions and shared capacities;.

Model answer (248 words):

Introduction: Globalisation can operate through neo-colonial structures, but the two concepts are not identical. Core analysis: The neo-colonial thesis explains how formally independent states remain dependent through finance, adverse trade terms, multinational corporations, technology and cultural power. Globalisation can deepen these mechanisms when powerful states and firms write rules, externalise risks and capture gains. Yet global interdependence also permits knowledge diffusion, new markets, transnational advocacy and coalitions among developing countries. OPEC and non-alignment illustrate the possibility of collective resistance, while treaty institutions can constrain powerful states as well as weaker ones when rules are reciprocal. Further development: Three tests sharpen the verdict. First, authorship: did weaker parties participate meaningfully in framing the rule? Second, distribution: are gains, risks and adjustment costs shared or extracted asymmetrically? Third, agency: can affected states build capacity, form coalitions and revise commitments? Where these fail, globalisation reproduces neo-colonial dependence behind formal consent. Where they are present, interdependence may be negotiated cooperation. The neo-colonial lens is therefore indispensable for exposing power, but insufficient if it treats every institution and flow as unilateral domination. Critical evaluation: The correct judgment is institutional and distributive rather than semantic. Globalisation becomes neo-colonial where consent is nominal, alternatives absent and benefits systematically extracted. It is cooperative where rule-making is inclusive, obligations reciprocal and weaker participants gain real capacity. Conclusion: Globalisation can reproduce neo-colonial asymmetry, yet it also creates reciprocal institutions, new coalitions and shared capacities; the answer depends on who authors the rules, distributes gains and retains meaningful exit.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *is* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Globalisation, Core and OPEC), converts that evidence into analysis of globalisation merely a new form of neo-colonialism? Critically discuss, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Globalisation can reproduce neo-colonial asymmetry, yet it also creates reciprocal institutions, new coalitions and shared capacities;. At 248 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.